FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-29-22001

Issue Title : Eaton Hydraulic Pump Shaft Seal Grommet - Material Composition Potential Escapement

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2911-00	-8, -8200, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
737NG	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/25/2022	05/25/2022	04/20/2022
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Description

Eaton Aerospace notified Boeing of a potential product reliability escapement of grommet seals as outlined in the reference a) Service Information Letter (SIL). Eaton identified certain instances where grommet rings showed erosion in the bore which can result in higher fluid drip rates.

Status

Boeing has coordinated with Eaton to analyze the material properties and compared them to the applicable design specification requirement. Analysis of the performance modulus at 100% elongation before and after fluid ageing test yielded results that did not meet Eaton's internal specification for change in modulus psi.

The modulus psi requirement (800psi minimum) at 100% elongation yielded a results approximately 10% below the required value from the non-conforming sub-component supplier. A slightly lower modulus psi after fluid aging may accelerate sealing surface degradation and suspect grommet seals may contribute to increased shaft seal leakage, but has attributed to small amounts of fluid weeping from the seals (drops).

Eaton tested both grommet seal materials (discrepant and new supply that meets spec) and showed that their performance to excessive heat was identical and resulted in material break up. As, such the suspect escapement does not have any impact/ correlations to EDP overheat failures and the commanded in-flight shutdown events. Both grommet seal materials had identical performance in the event of pump overheat, where the seals have been found to be severely degraded and have caused the loss of spring pressure on the main shaft seal; resulting in a high flow rate hydraulic fluid loss.

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FLEET TEAM DIGEST

Interim Action

Eaton Aerospace recommends that fielded product remain in service without further action unless grommet shaft seal leakage exceeds the limitations stated per applicable model Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM). Product found with excessive shaft seal leakage will be accepted for return and grommet replacement.

Furthermore, if a unit with a grommet from the suspect population is returned for any service (unrelated to shaft seal leakage), Eaton will proactively replace the grommet seals.

Final Action

Eaton recommends that in-service component assemblies continue to be used, as-is unless shaft seal leakage exceeds the maximum leakage rate permitted in accordance with the Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM). Product found with excessive shaft seal leakage will be accepted for return and grommet replacement. Product returned for any service (unrelated to shaft seal leakage) will have the grommet proactively replaced.

Final Corrective Action (Completed):

1. A new source for material is being used for the grommets.

2. Boeing has reviewed and approved of the new source of material.

3. All inventory from previous grommet seal supplier has been purged to prevent use.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: SEP 2021
Solution Selected:SEP 2021
Change Committed: FEB 2022
Production Incorporation: FEB 2022 (EDP Build Date)
Service Bulletin Available: N/A
Parts Available: N/A

Reference Categories

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Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Information Letter (SIL)	62983-29-01		

Related Categories

- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability

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